

Apple iPhone 16

Don't buy it yet

Apple's techtember is over and they have released their "latest and greatest" iPhones, the Apple Watch, and AirPods. Now the devices are hitting the shelves and have been at our test labs for us to evaluate. And what do you do when you get a phone that is being lauded as the best ever by the brand? Well, you put it through the churner to find out whether the phone, in this case, the Apple iPhone 16, is worth spending 80K on or whether you should hold back and buy it later. And given that Apple marketed their iPhone 16 lineup to be the first iPhone designed for Apple Intelligence, its absence was duly missed and noted when I put the iPhone 16 through our rigorous test process. Join in as we find out whether you should take the plunge right now, or wait till the price drops and Apple Intelligence is here in its full glory.

BUILD AND DESIGN

In terms of the design, at the front, the iPhone 16 isn't much of a departure from its predecessor, the iPhone 15 series of phones. The display hasn't changed much coming from the iPhone 15, other than the fact that the 16 has 0.4 per cent higher screen-to-body ratio. Good luck noticing that. Just like the last generation, you get a 60 Hz display, which is way behind its time now. Apple, please fix.

The biggest change that we get here is on the sides and the back of the phone. On the side, there is the much talked about Camera Control button, which works really well, only if you can reach it comfortably though. In my time of use, I often found it difficult to reach with my hands, so keep an eye out on that.

On the back, you get the new camera housing with the two cameras of the

₹79,990



phone arranged vertically in a much smaller island, which has exiled the flash to the side. The microphone retains its residency, though. When rested flat on the table without a cover, the phone wobbles quite a bit. And if I were you, I would either keep it screen-side down, or put it in a case. That's because the bottom camera housing makes direct contact with the table. And I am pretty sure, with time, it will pick up some scuffs.

The in-hand feel of the iPhone 16 is amazing with the rounded edges of the phone giving it a nice grip and feel. The aluminium housing is cold to touch and provides enough structural integrity to the phone, despite the new camera button adding a potential point of failure. And if you are one for carrying your phone as a style statement, then

you are in luck, as the iPhone 16 comes in 5 different colours to choose from. The one on with me is the Ultramarine colour, and honestly, I like it quite a bit.

Enough about the build and design. Let's talk about the features of the iPhone 16.

FEATURES

Right off the bat, the biggest highlight of the iPhone 16 series is Apple Intelligence. But, it won't be making an appearance on iPhones until next year, with support for Indian English, coming even later. Why even talk about it when you are not shipping it at the time of release?

Apple could have easily held back and announced its arrival at WWDC, much closer to the actual date of it showing up on iPhones. With that out of the way, iPhone 16 ships out of the box with iOS 18, which comes with its own trinkets and features that Apple fans had been waiting for years.

You can hide apps, lock them behind FaceID, and customise your home screen with much more control in your hands. Look at that, I can change the colour of my icons! WHAT A FEATURE?! Eh, Whatever.

The action button is the same from last year, and apart from that, there's not much to say. The compatibility of the iPhone with the rest of the devices in the ecosystem is as good as ever, and there's not much to complain about on the software side of things in daily use. iOS 18 is a much-needed step up, but it is not enough of a reason to upgrade to the 16. Now, on to the display.

DISPLAY

The display of the iPhone 16 is same as that of the base 15 from last year. The 6.7-inch Super Retina XDR OLED panel has great colour representation, and you get what you would expect from an iPhone – Vivid colours that are pleasing to the eye and deep blacks, making content consumption a fairly immersive experience when viewing high-fidelity content on platforms like Netflix.

In terms of the brightness, the iPhone peaked at 1568 nits of brightness